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Data Handling

Data Handling

Data handling and storage, file system structure, databasing, and more.

Proper handling of data is critical to running biosensor research studies.

Privacy

Along with conducting research comes the responsibility of ensuring that you follow all legal protection laws associated with collecting and storing data. Please consult your legal departments for information on how to treat and handle your data.

Organizing your data

Staying organized is extremely important to set yourself up for success, especially when it comes time to compile all of your data and generate insights. Organization starts before you even begin conducting your experiment! Follow these steps to ensure smooth operations, from study setup to final report writing:

Setting up your experiment

- While designing your experiment in iMotions, it is critical that you properly name anything and everything that will show up in your exports. So, this process begins with the stimuli you will be testing. Let's say you are running a static image test and you are testing 6 different package designs. These static images will show up in your export with the same name in your iMotions study. If your file name is IMG4567, it might be difficult to keep referring back to the study rather than initially naming it something easily identifiable, like "Competitor package, V2." You can change the name of your stimuli within iMotions before you begin data collection.
- Naming comes into play in various different portions of the software. Whether you are naming a stimuli block, runnable slideshow, survey question, survey answer, or the study itself, always be mindful of proper naming conventions that will make your life that much easier when handling and analyzing your data.

Storing your data

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- Once you have run participants in your study, the next step is managing the data you have collected.
- Perhaps you have multiple days of data collection with multiple different stations. To ensure your data is safely saved, we recommend saving your study at the end of each day. For organization, create a folder system that makes sense to you. It might look like:
- Day 1 Station 1
- Day 1 Station 2
- Day 2 Station 1
- Day 2 Station 2
- Save your iMotions file to these folders each day to stay organized. It is always smart to have a backup of your data on an external hard drive, to ensure against any potential loss of your data.

Deleting data

- It’s important to be mindful of international and/or institutional regulations regarding the anonymization, storage and deletion of content, in particular with regards to face recordings of individuals.
- Under the European General Data Protection Regulation, personal information (such as face recordings) may only be stored for a limited amount of time and according to the rules the respondents have consented to.
- To anonymize your study, consider giving your respondent an anonymous participant code instead of inserting their real names as respondents.
- Refer to our help center for information on how to export a version of your study without facial recordings.

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